

aug 22nd 2025

reducing **returns** with **consumer incentives**

audrey hillman, eliot geer, paul long, sophie sisson

agenda

1

introduction

- project overview
- meet the intern team

2

problem and scope

- **environmental** impacts
- the hidden cost of returns
- what is the market value?

3

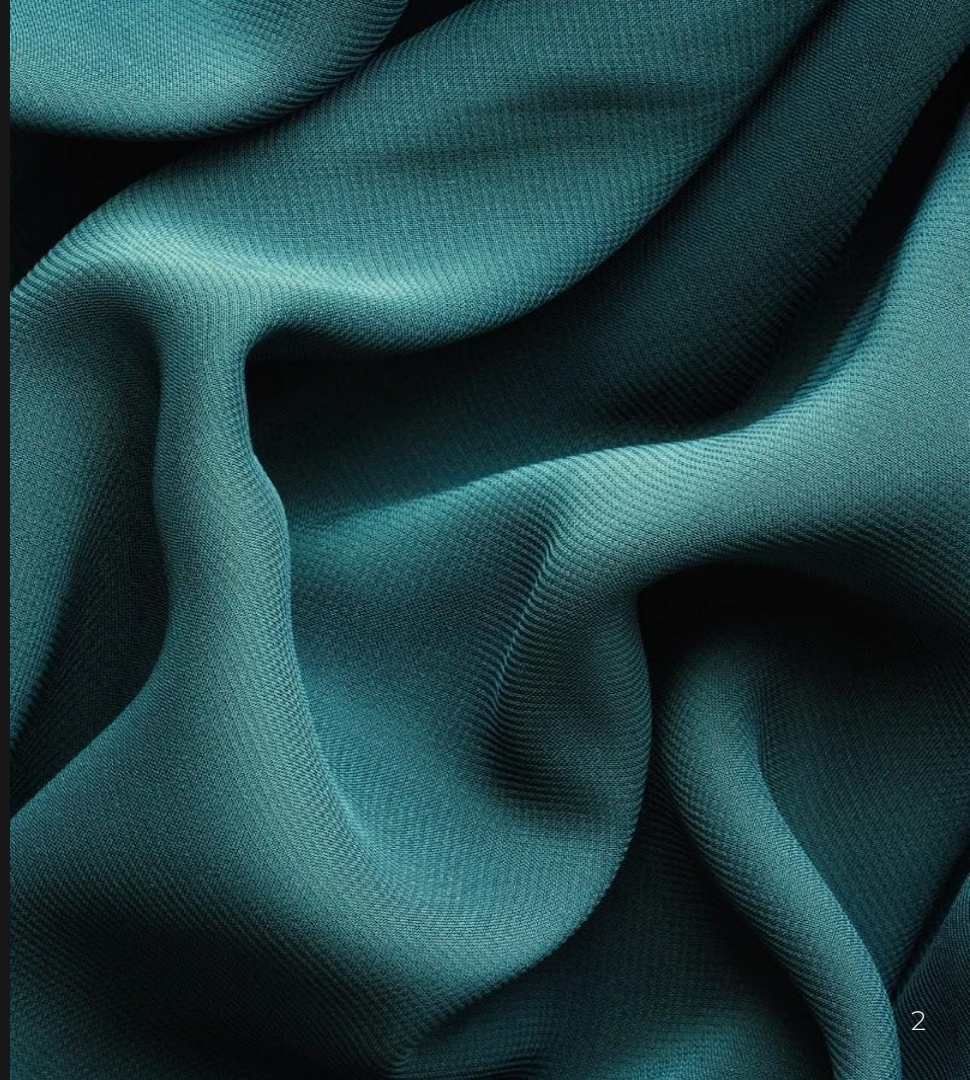
opportunity

- **affiliate** / influencer marketing
- **gamification** and e-commerce
- **social** shopping
- agentic ai and eddy

4

intersections and ideas

- three big ideas
- concluding thoughts



the problem:

If size-and-fit-related returns are the main cause of profit loss for the fashion industry, then **fierce** must create a shopping experience that is engaging, sustainable, distributable, and regret-free.

our solution:

We have found that there exists a complex ecosystem that connects the topics of **environmentalism**, **affiliate marketing**, **gamification**, **social shopping**, and **agentic AI** in today's shopping world. We believe that if **fierce** takes advantage of these intersections in **3 ways**, it will benefit both brands and consumers alike.

the intern team

eliot geer

- **Rising junior** at Brown University
- **Majors:** *Computer Science + Modern Culture and Media*
- **Internship Focus:** Instagram Shopping, UGC, and shareable content



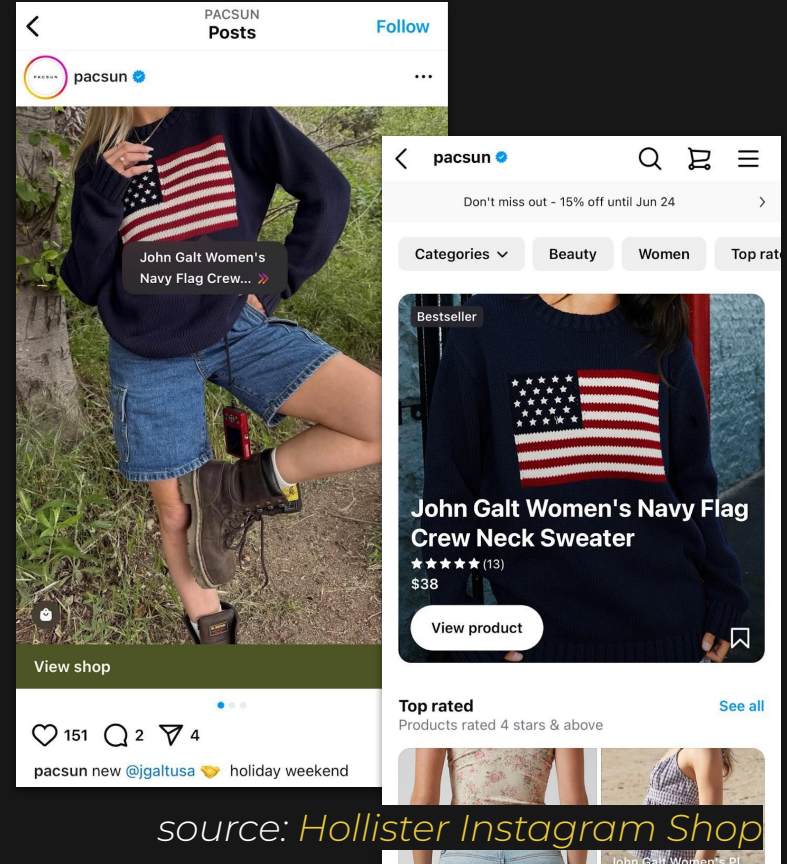
social shopping

social shopping intro

social shopping: using social media platforms to facilitate the e-commerce customer experience

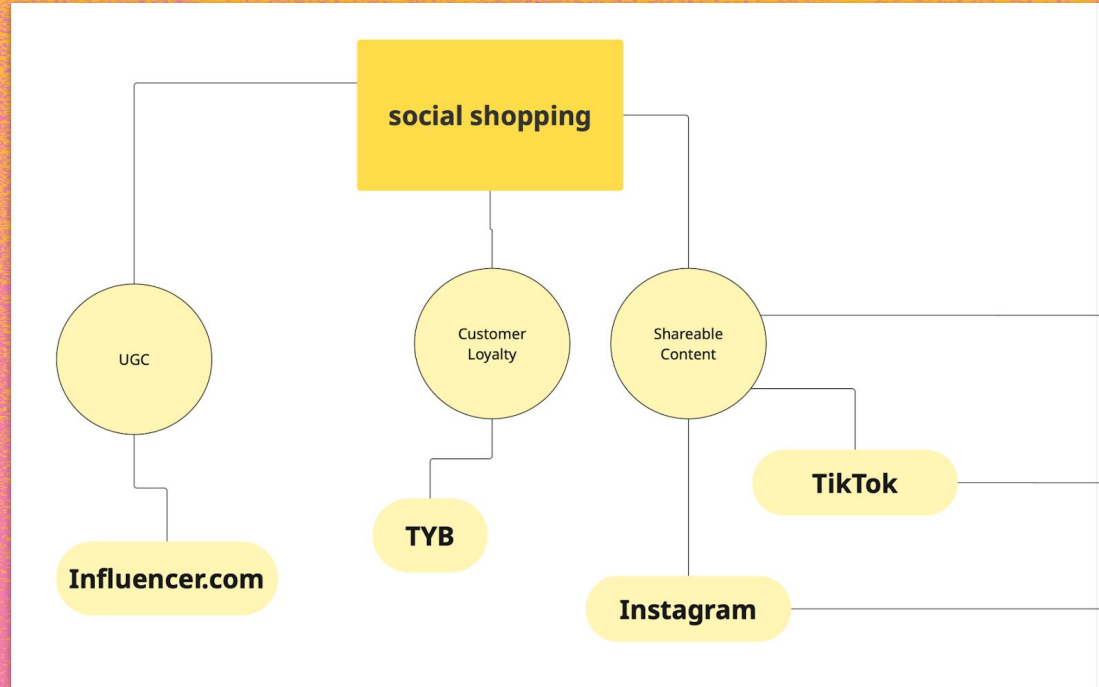
- differs from **traditional e-commerce**
- **examples:**
 - *Instagram* shopping
 - *TikTok* shop

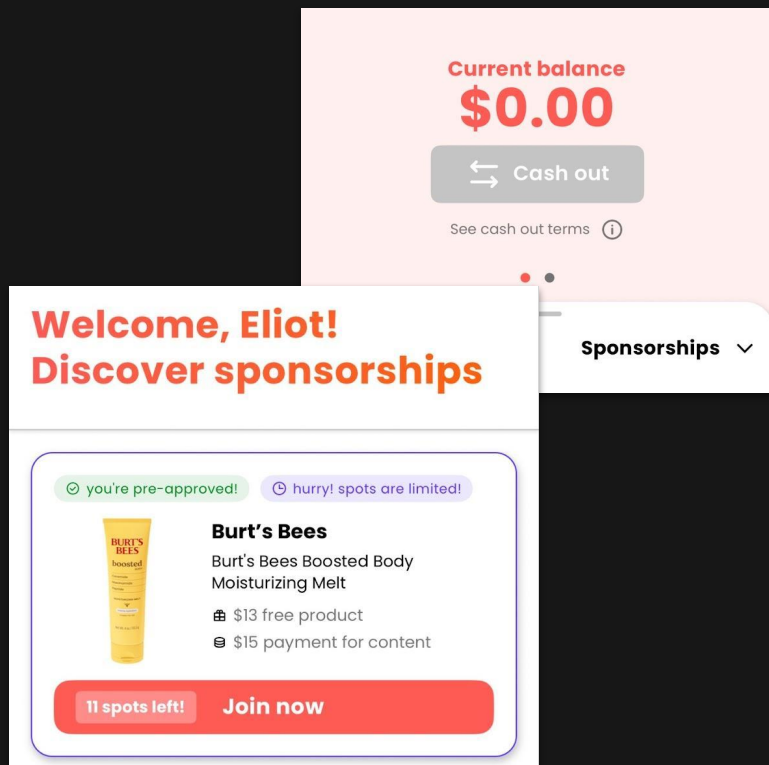
takeaways: creating a seamless path from post to purchase



source: *Hollister Instagram Shop*

social shopping landscape diagram





source: *WeSponsored*

UGC marketing creation

UGC: stands for user-generated content

- differs from **influencer marketing**
- mediated by sites such as *influencer.com*, *Upfluence*, *HeyCollabs*

+28% BRAND ENGAGEMENT

when consumers are exposed to a mix of **professional content** + **UGC**¹

takeaways: creating relatable content; turn people from consumers to creators

shareable content research

shareable content: digital content meant to be shared in online social spaces

what do people share?

users on social media care particularly about signaling their **personal values** through **shareable content** on social platforms¹

why does it matter?

in 2019, *Spotify Wrapped* generated²:

60 MILLION

to engage with the
feature in-app

1.2 MILLION

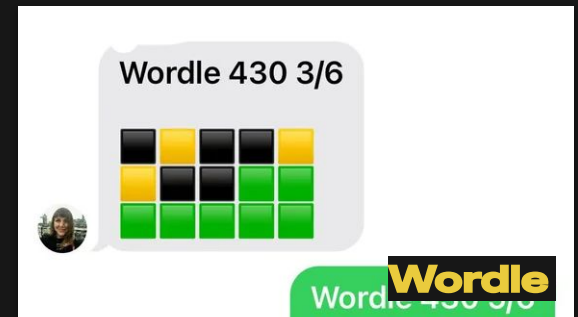
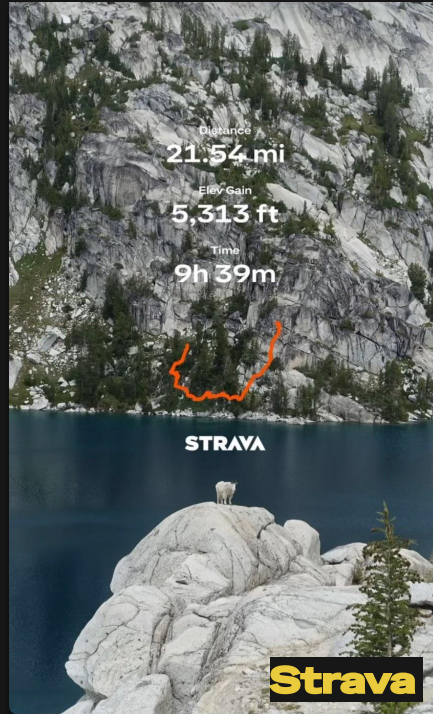
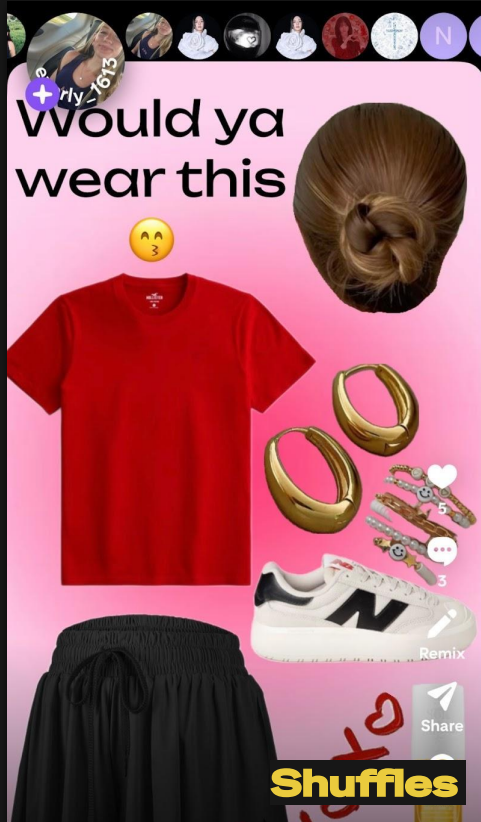
posts regarding the
feature on *Twitter*

takeaways: shareable content acts as natural advertising and should reflect customer identity

1. *Penn Today*

2. *Forbes*

shareable content examples



social shopping + shareable content conclusions

- **social shopping** and **sharing** account for a rapidly increasing percentage of digital purchases, especially with Gen Z consumers
- **shareable content** creates virality, organic reach, and fosters community, which are crucial for the launch of a product like **fierce**

44%

of Gen Z follow /
learn about brands
on *Instagram*¹

79%

surveyed have purchased
a product after watching
Instagram Reels¹

59.9%

of the world uses
social media¹

1. *Instagram*

2. *UMaine*

intersections and **ideas**

fierce wrapped concept

imagine: a yearly *Spotify Wrapped*-esque roundup of a **fierce** user's try-on, shopping, and return behaviors

- include an emphasis on **environmental impact**:
 - how many outfits did you save from the landfill?
 - how do your shopping behaviors compare to others globally?
- easily **shareable** in *Instagram* story or *TikTok* video format
- create friendly **competition** amongst users through leaderboards and global rankings
- incentivize **affiliate promotion** through shareable commission-based links, encouraging influencers and creators to share their **fierce wrapped** with their followers
- use **agentic AI** to provide personalized style recommendations

fierce wrapped concept

benefits to fierce:

- potential viral attention to the service
- trackable engagement metrics on how **fierce** is being used, and by whom

benefits to brands:

- additional insight into consumer shopping behaviors and demographics
- provides insight into customer shopping pipelines brand discoverability



fierce wrapped mockup



thank you!